Additional ASI digs until the valley's submersion in 1960 uncovered more finds, especially by T.N. Ramachandran in 1938 and the frantic ones between 1954 and 1960 under R. Subrahmanyam. They found Stone Age tools and over hundred inscriptions and megaliths from 136 sites across 24 sq. km, suggesting 5000 years of habitation in the valley. A Neolithic cemetery and megalithic tombs from the first millennium BCE, found here and across south India, show that burial for the dead was once common among Dravidian peoples.[4] While cremation too was known, it likely grew in importance as the Indo-Aryan culture, including Brahminism and Buddhism, spread to the south from the first millennium BCE.[5] Both cremation and burial were found in Vijayapuri. Cremation was likely part of a larger cultural package from the north in which caste and its particular forms of patriarchy were key ingredients,[6] forever transforming the more egalitarian matrilineal societies of the south (possibly a Harappan legacy). Interestingly, the anti-Brahminical Dravidian Movement in Tamil Nadu has demoted cremation in recent decades, and revived 'their' ancient custom of burying the dead. Many of its leaders, such as M.G. Ramachandran, J. Jayalalithaa and M. Karunanidhi, received a funerary burial.

The finest and the most monumental finds in the valley, however, date from the historical era when Vijayapuri, the capital of the Ikshvaku Dynasty flourished here in the third and fourth centuries CE. Falling into ruin thereafter, the city was consumed by the jungle. A small settlement arose in the vicinity during the Chalukyas (from seventh to twelfth centuries) and again in the fifteenth and sixteenth centuries, but they mostly fell outside the previously inhabited area of Vijayapuri in the valley, most of which lay undisturbed for nearly 1600 years; though levelled by the elements and the jungle, and parts of it raided by later settlers for building materials. The damage could easily have been far worse.